FR. CONCEICAO RODRIGUES COLLEGE OF ENGINEERING

Department of Computer Engineering
Academic Year 2025-26

Rubrics for Lab Experiments

Class : **B.*E. Computer Engineering*** **Subject Name :*SMA Lab***

Semester : **VIII** **Subject Code : *CSDL8023***

Practical No:	7
Title:	**Analyze how Individual / Organization use Social Media and Social media privacy policies.**
Date of Performance:	02/12/25
Roll No:	9913
Name of the Student:	Mark Lopes

Evaluation:

Performance Indicator	Below average	Average	Good	Excellent	Marks
On time Submission (2)	Not submitted (0)	Submitted after deadline (1)	Early or on time submission(2)	---	

Test cases and output (4)	Incorr ect output (1)	The expected output is verified only a for few test cases (2)	The expected output is Verified for all test cases but is not presentable (3)	Expected output is obtained for all test cases. Presentable and easy to follow (4)	
Coding efficiency (2)	The code is not structured at all (0)	The code is structured but not efficient (1)	The code is Structured and efficient. (2)	-	
Knowledge(2)	Basic concepts not clear (0)	Understood the basic concepts (1)	Could explain the concept with suitable example (1.5)	Could relate the theory with real world application(2)	
Total					

Aim: Analyze how Individual / Organization use Social Media and Social media privacy policies.
Objective: Analyze anyone Individual or Organization/Business usage on different platforms and privacy policy settings.

Case Study 1:
Choose a popular current issue of public debate (a bill under consideration, an election, or a political issue).
Search Twitter for posts about that issue.
What opinions are you able to find? Summarize them.
Is one opinion dominating the others?
Do you find a lot of content repeated? Perhaps one or two tweets that are repeated by many accounts? Does this appear suspicious, or is there a reason for it?

Case Study 2:
Choose any Company /organization of your choice. Analyze its usage of SM **Ex:-**
Blendtec, a manufacturer of high-end blenders , Zappos customer service

Case Study 3 :

Find Any company as an example of Social Media Failure and analyze the cause of failure .

Case Study 4:

Find a company that has undertaken a viral marketing campaign over social media. What is the essence of the campaign?
What metrics can you use to measure it (number of views, fans, likes, etc.)? Is the campaign ongoing, or did it run for a fixed amount of time?
Are any statistics available to indicate the success of the campaign? If so, what are they?

Case Study 5:

Choose two social media websites. Pull up their privacy policies and answer the following questions for each.
What information will be collected about you?
How much of that information is really necessary for you to use the site? Are they asking for more than they need?
Do you have access to all the information stored about you?
How will your information be shared with third parties?
Can your data be sold?
Are you allowed to permanently delete your data from the system?This is a great set of case studies covering various aspects of social media analysis. Since I cannot directly search live Twitter feeds or analyze real-time campaigns, I will use published information and existing analyses to provide the answers.
I will structure the response using a Q&A format for each case study as requested, ensuring it is a straight, continuous block of text without extra formatting elements like tables, headings, or horizontal rules.

Case Study 1: Public Debate on Social Media (Issue: Climate Change Policy)

Question: What opinions are you able to find? Summarize them.

Answer: Analysis of posts on X (formerly Twitter) about climate change policy typically reveals four dominant narrative clusters. The Policy Cluster focuses on the urgency of mitigation, supporting strong governmental action (like reducing greenhouse gas emissions) and referencing credible sources such as the IPCC and major news outlets. The Scientific Cluster emphasizes scientific data and findings to affirm the reality and human cause of climate change, often citing scientists and peer-reviewed journals. The Anthropogenic Cluster debates the core issue of whether climate change is real or human-caused, often including skeptical or denialist viewpoints and relying more on user-generated content. The Conspiracy Cluster links climate change initiatives to broader, often political, conspiracies, utilizing similar user-generated platforms.

Question: Is one opinion dominating the others?

Answer: The debate is highly polarized rather than dominated by a single opinion. While there is a vast amount of content supporting the consensus view on the reality and urgency of climate change, the opposing, skeptical, and denialist viewpoints are extremely well-represented and vocal, often utilizing emotionally charged language and computational amplification techniques to maintain visibility and challenge the mainstream narrative.

Question: Do you find a lot of content repeated? Perhaps one or two tweets that are repeated by many accounts? Does this appear suspicious, or is there a reason for it?

Answer: Yes, a significant amount of repeated content is common. This repetition can be due to legitimate or suspicious reasons. Legitimate reasons include users engaging in mass amplification of messages from political leaders, activists (e.g., retweeting calls to action for a protest), or trusted news sources, which is a key mechanism of social movements. Suspicious reasons often involve computational propaganda, where content promoting misinformation, disinformation, or specific political narratives is repeated by bot accounts or coordinated networks (sock puppets) to artificially manufacture the appearance of a widespread public consensus or rapidly spread a narrative before fact-checkers can intervene.

Case Study 2: Company Usage of Social Media (Example: Blendtec)

Question: Choose any Company /organization of your choice. Analyze its usage of SM Ex:- Blendtec, a manufacturer of high-end blenders.

Answer: The chosen company is Blendtec, a manufacturer of high-end blenders. Their social media usage is defined by the viral YouTube campaign, "Will It Blend?" The essence of the strategy is to demonstrate the product's extreme durability and power through humorous and engaging video content. The videos feature CEO Tom Dickson attempting to blend unusual, non-food items (e.g., iPhones, rakes, expensive tech). This usage benefits the company by providing an authentic, shock-value demonstration of the key product benefit—power—in a highly shareable format, which led to high brand recognition and a reported 700%

increase in sales following the campaign's launch.

Analysis of SM Usage: The strategy was one of authentic product demonstration disguised as entertainment. The videos featured CEO Tom Dickson in a lab coat attempting to blend items that no reasonable person would put in a blender—like iPhones, golf balls, or a garden rake.

Essence of the Strategy: The central question, "Will It Blend?", created suspense and humor. It focused on the blender's single most important feature, its power and durability, in a way that was far more engaging than traditional advertising. The low-budget, quirky, and authentic style of the early videos was key to their success.

Benefit to the Company: The campaign generated massive brand awareness and, more importantly, a 700% increase in sales for the retail line of blenders over the following years. It successfully positioned the Blendtec as the undisputed champion of power.

Case Study 3: Social Media Failure (Example: Domino's Employee Incident)

Question: Find Any company as an example of Social Media Failure and analyze the cause of failure.

Answer: The company is Domino's Pizza (specifically a 2009 incident). The failure was caused by two Domino's employees who posted a video to YouTube showing themselves tampering with food in an unsanitary and disgusting manner. The cause of failure was twofold: first, the severe misconduct of the employees, and second, the speed and virality of social media (YouTube, Twitter) which allowed the negative, brand-damaging content to spread rapidly and bypass traditional corporate communication control. Domino's exacerbated the crisis by initially taking too long (days) to acknowledge the incident, allowing the negative narrative to dominate. The failure forced the company president to issue a public, video-recorded apology to mitigate the severe reputational damage.

Company/Incident: The failure occurred in April 2009 when two employees at a Domino's franchise in North Carolina posted a disgusting video to YouTube showing them performing unsanitary and repulsive acts (like putting cheese up their nose and then placing it on sandwiches) while preparing food for customers.

Cause of Failure: The immediate cause was the gross misconduct of the employees. The social media failure, however, was Domino's initial crisis management strategy. The video quickly went viral, attracting over a million views, yet the company took too long—nearly two days—to publicly address the situation.

Analysis: Domino's initially relied on traditional crisis methods, hoping the video would disappear. This failed in the 24/7 social media environment, allowing the narrative to be controlled by the negative video and user outrage. The crisis was only mitigated after the company president, Patrick Doyle, posted a sincere video apology on YouTube (using the same medium as the attack) and initiated immediate action, including firing and pressing criminal charges against the employees. This incident taught brands the crucial lesson that social media crises require an immediate, transparent, and platform-relevant response.

Case Study 4: Viral Marketing Campaign (Example: The ALS Ice Bucket Challenge)

Question: Find a company that has undertaken a viral marketing campaign over social media. What is the essence of the campaign?

Answer: The campaign is The ALS Ice Bucket Challenge (Summer 2014). While not a traditional company, it was a marketing campaign for the ALS Association. The essence was a unique combination of altruism, social pressure, and fun. Participants poured a bucket of ice water over their head, filmed it, and then nominated three others to do the same within 24 hours or donate to ALS research. This created a Chain Reaction of user-generated content (UGC) fueled by peer-to-peer challenge.

Question: What metrics can you use to measure it (number of views, fans, likes, etc.)?

Answer: Key metrics used to measure this campaign's success include: Reach/Impressions (total unique views—watched 10 billion times on Facebook), Engagement (likes, comments, and shares—generated 28 million Facebook engagements), User-Generated Content (UGC) (number of original videos created—over 17 million uploaded to Facebook), Conversion Rate (Financial) (the amount of money raised), and Donor Acquisition Rate (the number of first-time donors).

Question: Is the campaign ongoing, or did it run for a fixed amount of time?

Answer: The major, exponential viral phase of the campaign ran for a fixed, short amount of time (primarily 8 weeks in the summer of 2014). It continues to be referenced and revisited as an annual activity, but its period of peak velocity was fixed.

Question: Are any statistics available to indicate the success of the campaign? If so, what are they?

Answer: Yes, the statistics overwhelmingly indicate success. The campaign raised over $115 million for the ALS Association in the U.S. in just eight weeks, compared to $2.3 million the previous year. It acquired over 17 million new donors and the funds raised have directly contributed to important scientific breakthroughs, including the discovery of new ALS genes.

Essence of the Campaign: It was a peer-to-peer challenge blending fun, social pressure, and altruism. Participants had to dump a bucket of ice water over their head, film it, and then nominate three others to do the same within 24 hours or donate money to the ALS Association.

Key Campaign Mechanics:

- Simplicity: The task required only a bucket, water, ice, and a phone—making it accessible to almost anyone.
- Social Pressure: The public nomination system created a sense of obligation and fear of missing out (FOMO), driving exponential participation.
- Visual Appeal: The act of being drenched in ice water was inherently entertaining and shareable.

Metrics for Measurement: Key metrics included User-Generated Content (UGC) (17 million videos uploaded to Facebook), Total Views/Reach (watched over 10 billion times), and the most critical, Financial Conversion and Donor Acquisition.

Campaign Duration & Success: The high-velocity, viral phase ran for a fixed, short amount of time (approximately 8 weeks in summer 2014). It was an undeniable success, raising over $115 million for the ALS Association in the U.S. in that short period (a massive increase from $2.3 million the previous year) and bringing in 17 million new donors. These funds directly led to significant advances in ALS research.

Case Study 5: Social Media Privacy Policies (General Analysis)

Question: Choose two social media websites. Pull up their privacy policies and answer the following questions for each. What information will be collected about you?

Answer: Information Collected: Virtually all platforms (e.g., Meta/Facebook, X/Twitter) collect extensive data, including Information You Provide (name, email, date of birth, content you post); Information Collected Automatically (IP address, device type, operating system, precise location via GPS/Wi-Fi, and extensive behavioral data like every click, scroll, and time spent on a post); and Information from Third Parties (data from partners, advertisers, and other services you link to your account).

Question: How much of that information is really necessary for you to use the site? Are they asking for more than they need?

Answer: Only basic information (email/phone, password, IP address for security) is truly necessary for core function. Yes, they are asking for significantly more than they need. The exhaustive collection of behavioral and interest data is primarily driven by the platform's business model (targeted advertising and monetization), not merely to provide the basic social networking service.

Question: Do you have access to all the information stored about you?

Answer: No. Platforms offer tools to download a copy of your data (posts, messages, contacts), but you typically do not have access to the platform's proprietary analytical data, such as the internal algorithmic scores of your interests, detailed server logs, or the specific data points used to qualify you for a particular ad campaign.

Question: How will your information be shared with third parties?

Answer: Information is shared with Service Providers (vendors who help run the service like cloud hosting), Advertisers (often in aggregated or pseudonymous forms to facilitate targeted ad placement and measurement), and when legally required by Government/Regulatory Bodies (e.g., responding to a subpoena).

Question: Can your data be sold?

Answer: Yes, in effect. While they rarely sell your name and address directly for a fixed price, the underlying behavioral, demographic, and interest data is the primary product that is sold to advertisers in the form of guaranteed ad exposure to specific, highly refined user profiles. Furthermore, policies typically reserve the right to transfer all data to a new entity in the event of a merger, acquisition, or sale of assets.

Question: Are you allowed to permanently delete your data from the system?

Answer: Yes, but with caveats. Most platforms allow for a permanent account deletion, but this process often includes a grace period (e.g., 30 days) during which the account can be restored. Additionally, policies typically state that some residual data may remain in backup archives or logs for a longer period, and content required for legal compliance or fraud prevention may never be fully deleted.